



Ventura Motors – Crown Coaches

MN-70013

Phase 1 Determination

Acquisition may be put into effect

7 May 2026

1. Determination and statement of reasons

Notified acquisition	Ventura Motors NewCo Pty Ltd, a wholly owned subsidiary of Ventura Motors Pty Ltd (together with its subsidiaries, Ventura Motors) proposes to acquire the business assets (including the vehicles, plant and equipment, IP and IP licences, goodwill, and business records) of Crown Coaches Pty Ltd and Crown Hybrid Pty Ltd that constitute the Crown Coaches business (Crown Coaches) (the Acquisition).
Determination	The Australian Competition and Consumer Commission has determined under section 51ABZE(1) of the <i>Competition and Consumer Act 2010</i> (Cth) that the Acquisition may be put into effect.
Parties to the Acquisition	The acquirer, Ventura Motors, is an Australian bus operator primarily active in metropolitan Melbourne. It supplies metropolitan bus services, public school bus services, and private school and other private charter bus services, as well as regional intercity coach transport. The target, Crown Coaches, is a family-owned bus operator that supplies public school bus services, and private school and other private charter bus services in metropolitan Melbourne.
Overlap between the parties	Ventura Motors and Crown Coaches both supply: - bus services to public specialised schools in metropolitan Melbourne - private charter bus services in metropolitan Melbourne.
Reasons for determination	When making a determination in Phase 1, the Australian Competition and Consumer Commission (ACCC) undertakes a competition assessment and considers whether it is appropriate for an acquisition to be approved or subject to further assessment in Phase 2 in accordance with section 51ABZJ of the <i>Competition and Consumer Act 2010</i> (Cth) (the Act). In doing so, the ACCC must have regard to the object of the Act and all relevant matters, including the interests of consumers. For more information about the ACCC's approach to considering notified acquisitions, see the ACCC's merger assessment guidelines and interim merger process guidelines. In conducting its competition assessment, the ACCC has considered the information and documents that were submitted with the notification form, information from third parties, and publicly available information. The ACCC has determined that the Acquisition may be put into effect as it considers that the Acquisition is unlikely to have the effect of substantially lessening competition in any market. In reaching its decision, and based on the material before it, the ACCC makes the following findings. Notwithstanding a concern expressed by a third party that the Acquisition may reduce options available to customers, post-acquisition, the merged firm would likely continue to face competition from alternative suppliers of public specialised school bus services and private charter bus services in

	metropolitan Melbourne. • The aggregation arising from the Acquisition is low in relation to public specialised school bus services and private charter bus services in metropolitan Melbourne.
Applications for review	A notifying party, or other person who has been allowed to do so by the Australian Competition Tribunal, may apply for review if they are dissatisfied with the determination. Pursuant to section 100C of the Act, applications for review of the determination are to be made to the Australian Competition Tribunal before the end of 14 calendar days after this statement of reasons was included on the ACCC's Acquisitions Register. To confirm whether there has been any application for review, please contact the Australian Competition Tribunal.

Determination made by Commissioner Philip Williams pursuant to a delegation under section 25(1) of the Act